Relief Held

S&P +0.54% to 6,592. Oil fell 4% on 15-point peace plan. AMD +7.26% on CPU pricing power. Gold $4,502.

THE SESSION

The pattern broke. For the first time this week, pre-market optimism held through the close. The S&P 500 gained 0.54% to 6,592, the Dow added 305 points (+0.66%), and the Nasdaq rose 0.77%. The Russell 2000 led at +1.23%, a broad-based risk bid that did not fade by midday. The catalyst was familiar—a 15-point ceasefire proposal delivered to Iran via Pakistan—but the market's willingness to hold the gap was new. Previous sessions saw peace-plan rallies evaporate by late morning. Wednesday's held.

Oil's response gave the rally structural support. Brent crude fell roughly 4% to settle near $96 per barrel, the sharpest single-session decline since Iran rejected the initial Hormuz mediation on March 18. WTI dropped to approximately $88. The pullback in energy costs eased inflation-premium fears and pushed Treasury yields lower—the 10-year retreated to 4.32%, down from 4.42% at Tuesday's close. That combination of falling oil and falling yields gave equities room to breathe for the first time in a week.

Every sector except energy closed higher. Semiconductors led the session after Nikkei Asia reported that both AMD and Intel have informed customers of 10–15% CPU price increases amid worsening supply constraints. Delivery lead times have extended from one–two weeks to eight–twelve weeks, with some orders stretching to six months. AMD surged 7.26% to $220.27. Gold climbed 2.28% to $4,502, pulling miners sharply higher. Bitcoin recovered 2.22% to $70,956. The VIX fell 6% to 25.33.

Iran received the 15-point plan but has not formally responded. The IRGC's counter-demands from earlier this week—US base closures, reparations, Hormuz tolls—remain the stated position. Goldman Sachs noted that crude is trading on the perceived probability of worst-case scenarios rather than the base case, and its base case still assumes Hormuz flows normalize in April. The five-day pause expires Saturday. The market is pricing hope; confirmation is still outstanding.

IOWN Tactical: S&P 500 at 6,592 remains well within the hold zone. No trim or buy triggers active. The overnight de-escalation moved oil more than equities—watch whether Brent holds below $100 through the week.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

AMD +7.26% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Nikkei Asia reported AMD and Intel plan 10–15% CPU price hikes amid a deepening supply crunch. Server CPU lead times have stretched to 8–12 weeks. Hyperscaler demand has consumed most of 2026 allocated volume. Pricing power in a constrained environment.

HOOD +5.01% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Robinhood's board authorized a $1.5 billion share buyback program, adding $1.1 billion in fresh capacity. Shares are down 39% year-to-date; management signaled confidence in long-term value at current levels.

AEM +4.68% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold surged 2.28% to $4,502 as geopolitical hedging demand persisted alongside falling real yields. Agnico Eagle led the gold mining sleeve higher.

PDD +4.61% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Q4 revenue rose 12% year-over-year to RMB 123.9 billion. Transaction services revenue grew 19%. Management guided for significant supply chain investment in 2026, warning of near-term profit pressure.

HUT +4.45% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Bitcoin recovered 2.22% to $70,956 as risk appetite returned. Hut 8 tracked the move higher alongside the broader digital asset recovery.

GFI +3.96% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold Fields benefited from the same gold-price tailwind as AEM. The precious metals complex remains a portfolio ballast amid elevated geopolitical uncertainty.

DECLINERS

VLO –2.98% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Oil's 4% decline weighed on refining margins. Valero traded inversely with the ceasefire optimism—if Hormuz normalizes, refining spreads narrow. This is the portfolio's intended hedge behavior.

LRCX –2.26% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Gave back a portion of Tuesday's +2.37% gain. The AMD/Intel CPU pricing story favored the chipmakers themselves over equipment names in Wednesday's session.

KEYS –1.83% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Similarly reversed part of Tuesday's +3.33% advance. Keysight traded with the equipment complex, not the CPU pricing beneficiaries.

ADP –1.36%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Pullback on no specific catalyst. ADP drifted lower in a session that favored cyclical and commodity-linked names over defensive compounders.

HOLDINGS NEWS

AMD / Intel CPU pricing. Nikkei Asia reported both companies have notified customers of price increases across CPU product lines, effective March (Intel) and April (AMD). Average hikes range 10–15%, with some products seeing steeper increases. The shortage reflects AI-driven hyperscaler demand absorbing server CPU inventory. AMD's EPYC Venice (2nm) is targeted for H2 2026. This is a structurally positive development for AMD's pricing power and revenue growth trajectory.

HOOD buyback. Robinhood authorized $1.5 billion in share repurchases over three years, adding $1.1 billion in new capacity to prior programs. The company has already repurchased 22 million shares at an average price of $40.64 under earlier authorizations. With shares down 39% year-to-date from the October 2025 peak, management is buying into weakness. The expanded $3.25 billion revolving credit facility provides additional financial flexibility.

PDD Q4 earnings. Revenue of RMB 123.9 billion (+12% YoY) beat expectations. Transaction services grew 19% while online marketing grew 5%. Net income declined 11% as the company increased investment spending. Management emphasized "all-in" supply chain investment for 2026, warning that profitability will face short-term pressure. Cash and short-term investments stood at RMB 422 billion ($60.4 billion).

OKE price target raised. Wall Street lifted ONEOK's price target to $100, reflecting improved midstream fundamentals. OKE gained 1.30% to $92.12.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✗ TRAIL

+0.28%

vs. DVY +0.37% | IWS +0.55%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

+1.54%

vs. IUSG +0.61%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +5.19% vs DVY +5.94% / IWS +3.89%
Growth –1.42% vs IUSG –5.92%